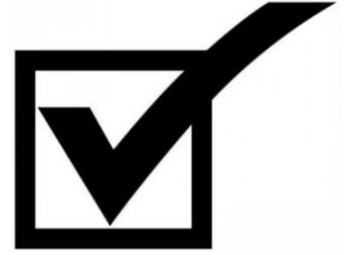




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2022

FINAL

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

STATE FINAL SCENARIO KEY:

Dan, a Marketing Analyst for Digital Solutions, has been unhappy for the past year, feeling that advancement opportunities are either very limited or completely unavailable in his current position. Last month, he made the decision to actively pursue other job opportunities with room for advancement and professional growth. Dan has chosen to keep this job search a secret from his current employer and has continued to perform well in his current position.

In recognition of Dan's outstanding job performance and, in private consideration of him as a future Assistant Manager of the Marketing Department, his supervisor signs him up for an out-of-town management training seminar that starts in two days at a substantial financial cost to the company. The registration cost of the seminar is non-refundable; however, the change deadline for the plane tickets and hotel arrangements has not yet occurred and, theoretically, could be changed to another employee, should one be available to attend.

Although a formal offer has not yet been extended to Dan by other employers, he did complete a second, very strong, interview today and feels confident that he will be offered the position within the week.

- What company ethics policies are involved in this scenario?
- Is it ethical for employers to treat employees differently if they know they are pursuing other jobs?
- Is it ethical for employees to pursue other jobs without informing their current employer?
- What decision(s) would you make if you were Dan and why?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Good business ethics requires that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside of the business.
- Paying respect to co-workers, oneself and clients, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional.

- Professionalism plays an important role in how a person is perceived by his/her employer, his/her co-workers and casual contacts.
- Strong leaders exhibit appropriate professional communication skills.
- A true professional knows the importance and liability of maintaining confidential information within the context of every business and/or personal situation.
- Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.
- Learning how to confidently interact with colleagues, clients and customers in a professional manner is vital for future success.
- A person uses his/her own personal values in the context of his/her business dealings.